

An Introduction to the Zend Framework 2



With this article, we begin a new column on Zend Framework 2, which is the most popular modern framework for high performance PHP applications. It is modular, secure, high performing, extensible, enterprise-ready and has vibrant community support. The author will present a series of tutorials on the topic. So stay tuned.

This article offers the basics about the Zend Framework, which could be helpful to those new to Zend Framework 2.

Core vs framework development

Choosing between core and framework development has always been a confusing decision for any developer. While deciding, developers should remember some points like feasibility analysis, functional analysis, market analysis, situation analysis, etc.

For example, if you are going to develop a to-do task list program, there can be two scenarios.

First, you may want it for your own use, or second, you may want it online so that any user can register, log in and get alerts at specified times, for which you can add paid and free membership into your account as well as other related functionality.

In the first scenario, it is fine if you use core development. There is no need to use any framework because of the limited, basic functionality required for personal use only.

In the second scenario, development in core PHP is also fine, but while doing so, you will find many repetitive tasks like database connection, SQL queries, validation of form data, etc. So in that case, developers will try to use OOP concepts to simplify these repetitive tasks. This concept results in the creation of your own framework that is designed into your project. But in this methodology,

the developer has to cover so many aspects like SQL injection, data privacy, more flexibility, avoiding code redundancy, etc.

Designing such a code library that can be reused in your other projects might become more complex to develop. A better decision is to go with already tried-and-tested PHP frameworks, if you anticipate that your functionality and requirements will grow, and get larger and more complex in the future.

What is a framework?

Frameworks are developed in core PHP itself, but designed in a more proper way, with a standard set of rules and goals. The framework developers always try to focus on making the system more scalable, secure and one that enables faster framework development.

So going with a framework for developing your project is always recommended, unless your requirement is similar to the first scenario.

You will find many frameworks like Zend, CakePHP, CodeIgniter, Yii, Symfony, Phalcon, Kohana, etc, in the market, some of which are very well known among developers.

So now for a developer, the question is, "Wow, there are so many Google results for 'PHP framework'; which one should I go with for my project?"

The answer to this is that each framework is unique in its development methodology. Frameworks like